

is given to the risks they pose. And as children get more and more clever at bypassing dictatorial parental control systems, it's more important for parents and adults to directly and emotionally communicate with their children regarding the dangers of new technology. Every device is a window into the world of the child and it's often impossible to know who's on the other side. The duty of the parent is to reinforce these windows to the best of their abilities given the age of the child. The need to talk and teach the child directly can never be overemphasised. Despite these proactive actions, however, adults need to place more rigid safeguards on younger, more vulnerable children. Applications, software, operating systems and other methods of protecting children online are a must-know for any responsible parent who allows their child to wander online.

Innovations in e-learning

The current state of the kids technology market is in a state of boom. The last few years have witnessed record growth for the under-12 years consumer segment in kids-oriented technologies. This ascension has coincided with the increasing technology penetration all over the world, especially within urban India. Since modern parents tend to live in a nuclear household, the reliance on technology is also high, as is the surplus income available to direct towards that end. The market, however, is highly fragmented and segmented in a number of areas including software apps, games, toys and devices. Interestingly, all these segments tend to stem from the same core which is education, making e-learning the key market within which the industry orients its growth.

The ability of e-learning for under-12 children has already borne fruit in the west. But recent progress in India itself has shown it to be a game-changing tool as in the case of 'The School in the Cloud' program. The program formally received funding in 2013 from scientist Sugata Mitra through the TED organisation. He had already set up five such programs in India prior to his \$1 million grant and has continued to expand them since then. His programs utilise the potential of using online resources to connect children with a 'Self Organised Learning Environment' or 'SOLE'. Using commercially free tools such as Skype, the program has let children in underprivileged areas direct their inquisitive and exploratory minds be guided by 'Skype Grannies'. These Skype Grannies are a volunteer force of retired elderly women in many countries across the world who use their free time to Skype and help the children as they